

introduced are backported to a previous minor version release. For example, tree conflicts introduced in 1.6.0 are not backported to the 1.5.0 release branch.

Let us take the case of the Subversion 1.6.x release and see how it gets affected between the bug fix releases. When Subversion 1.6 was officially released, it got the version number 1.6.0 with a number of new features, such as the following:

- Repository root relative URLs
- Detection of tree conflicts
- cTypes Python bindings
- Logging support for *svnserve*
- Support for file externals
- Sparse directory exclusion

Apart from the features introduced in this 1.6.0 release, there were many bug fixes and improvements to the existing features. Then, once in two months, Subversion developers started releasing 1.6.1, 1.6.2, etc. These included improvements and bug fixes on existing features and the features introduced in the 1.6.0 release.

There was a special case in the 1.6.x release branch, where the Subversion developers came up with a release 1.6.4, which was for just one security fix. In this release, bugs weren't fixed, but there was a single patch to fix a security issue in Subversion clients/servers. This could have been fixed as a part of a bug fix release in Subversion 1.6.4 but the developers did not want to wait for all the bug fixes scheduled for 1.6.4 to get in before they released the patch, which would also have to undergo a soak period of two months. The complete bug fix release that subsequently came out was version 1.6.5.

In any release, if you upgrade to the same minor version—that is, 6 in 1.6.4 or 1.6.5—you will not experience any difference in the software. The dependencies that worked for 1.6.0 will continue to work for 1.6.4, 1.6.5, etc, unless you decide to change the dependencies to a different version due to some

security reasons.

Hence, a user can choose the following paths to upgrade to 1.6.6, which is the latest version, as of writing this article:

- 1.6.0 to 1.6.6
- 1.6.1 to 1.6.6
- 1.6.2 to 1.6.6
- 1.6.3 to 1.6.6
- 1.6.4 to 1.6.6
- 1.6.5 to 1.6.6

This also applies to changing from any arbitrary version to one with the same minor number, like 1.6.2 to 1.6.4 and various similar combinations.

In case of Subversion 1.x.x and 2.x.x, all the above-mentioned compatibilities may or may not work. The Subversion community does not promise to preserve the backward compatibility between major versions of Subversion, in which case a 1.x.x client will not work smoothly with a 2.x.x server. Similarly, a 1.x.x server will not work smoothly with 2.x.x clients. Though we do not have a 2.x.x version of a Subversion release yet, this was the case with the 0.x.x Subversion release and the 1.x.x Subversion release.



Note: Subversion 1.6.4 and 1.5.7 are important security fix releases and all servers must be updated for this fix, if Subversion servers using HTTP, HTTPS or the SVN protocols are exposed to the public.

The latest release of the Subversion (1.6.6) source can be downloaded from <http://subversion.tigris.org>. If you want Subversion binaries for different platforms, visit <http://open.collab.net>. 

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